



PTAB Meeting Minutes: June 18, 2025

Present: Colleen O'Neill, Stacey Allott, Jimmy Cunningham, Ashley Garwood, Ezra Schwartzberg, Mary Thill, Aurora White (Village Trustee), Julia Goren (Public Attendee)

Meeting called to order by Chair at 6:07 p.m.

1. Approve May Meeting Minutes: Motion by Mary Thill, Second by Stacey

2. New Business:

1. Adirondack Rail Trail Association (ARTA) Update from Julia Goren, Executive Director
 - Provided an update and answered questions from PTAB.
 - Final segment Floodwood Road to Tupper Lake will open ~September.
 - Amenity/Community Navigation Signage: NYSDEC provides signage within 50' of corridor for amenities like food, gas, mile marker, interpretive and historical info. Municipalities (Lake Placid, Saranac Lake, Tupper Lake) manage signage to help people navigate safely from parking, businesses and schools to the trail like universal navigation signs, parking, direction to downtown along the select main routes. ARTA would like consistent signage across Lake Placid, Saranac Lake and Tupper Lake.
 - Action Items:
 1. Colleen will talk with Office of Community Development and Doug Haney about universal navigation signage locations and process.
 2. Julia will try to build bridges between PTAB and Placid/Tupper analogs
 - Fowlers Crossing Safety: PTAB's 2024 request to NYSDOT for a lower speed limit was denied. There is discussion of adding a flashing pedestrian sign.
 - Action Items:
 1. PTAB will share past research and NYSDOT correspondence with Julia. One idea is traffic-calming engineering, e.g., a median or lane narrowing.
 2. Julia will contact NYSDOT with usage data and consensus that current situation cannot continue.
 - Reconnecting Woodruff Street: NYSDEC's 100' ROW is pretty much entire hill. A pedestrian connector ramp would entail a complicated process; NYSDEC would have to be involved as it's their jurisdiction.
 - Action Item:
 1. Colleen to send Julia PTAB's past pedestrian connector documentation.
2. PTAB Budget Usage for Survey of Proposed Sidewalk improvements and Traffic Change on Main/Church/Pine Street Corridor:

- The Village Board asked PTAB to provide 50% (\$1,500) of the cost of a survey of upper Main Street. PTAB members expressed support for the idea but asked questions about PTAB's budget (process, amount, prioritization).
 - Action Item: Aurora and Colleen will clarify budget logistics with Katrina

3. Unfinished Business:

1. Initiative and Park Updates

- **Baldwin:** Confirmed there is a time capsule near the current memorial, put there by a veterans group. Keep in mind once construction starts. Jordanna Mallach might know more on exact location.
- **Boothe River Park:** Focus is on fundraising and grants. Office of Community Development will submit a CFA state grant application in July and Northern Border Regional Commission application in fall, and researching other financing. Duck Race fundraiser on 6/22.
- **Community Bike Ride:** ROOST will help promote but not fund. PTAB approved the effort of signage, t-shirts and replacing the No Smoking Sign and moving signage over to Riverside Park, but wanted more info on budget before voting. Action Item: Find out about budget and whether Village or PTAB to fund signage and T-shirts.
- **Garwood POW:** No update; waiting on state grant request.
- **Lake Colby:** Progress has been made on accessibility: universal access porta potties, tent changing station, wash station, and the path is ready for unrolling of the beach mat.
- **Mt. Pisgah:** Park Ave Trail Connector is delayed because AMA owners are planning a road where trail was planned and flagged; the trail will need to be re-planned and flagged. Peduzzi Trails has completed a trails plan. BETA's Saranac Lake Trails Committee met to discuss the plan and will present a report to the Village of Saranac Lake Board of Trustees.
- **Pollinator Habitats and Climate Planning:** No update.
- **Riverside Park:** No update. Action Items: Jimmy to reach out to Kirk Sullivan at Arts and Culture Advisory Board to get thoughts on the bandshell. Aurora to reach out to Village Manager to see if there are any other plans for the park.
- **Rail Trail Connections and Crossings:** No update.
- **Recycling Program:** No update.
- **Ward Plumadore:** Dan King, metalworks artist, intends to install mountainscape before July 4. On June 19 Kirk Sullivan was to brief selected village board and committee members on fire tower plans. June 23 the board was to discuss whether to accept a Franklin County grant for the project. Dave Vana would attend to provide clarity re: budget, long-term maintenance and legal concerns.

4. Adjourn at 7:30 p.m.: Motion by Mary, Second by Ashley